



FLORIDA
LIQUOR LICENSE
MARKET
BUY • SELL • FINANCE • INVEST



THE OFFICIAL
FLORIDA
LIQUOR
LICENSE MARKET

BUYER'S AND SELLER'S GUIDE

Buying • Selling • Financing • Applying

2026 EDITION



FLORIDA LIQUOR LICENSE MARKET

2026
EDITION

**START HERE**

A practical guide to a high-stakes Florida transaction

For buyers, sellers, operators, investors, lenders, and quota-license applicants.

Florida liquor-license transactions sit at the intersection of market value, business planning, local land-use rules, financing, and state approval. This guide gives you a disciplined way to move from an idea to a properly documented transaction—without confusing a marketplace deal with the government licensing process.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Treat the license, the operating location, and the business assets as separate workstreams. They often close together, but each has different risks, documents, and approval conditions.

Use this guide to

Choose the license privileges that match your operation.

Compare buying an existing quota license, entering the annual drawing, or qualifying for a non-quota or special license.

Decide whether to use a broker-assisted process or manage the transaction yourself.

Organize due diligence, financing, the DBPR application, and closing.

Prepare the information FLLM needs to help with a search, listing, valuation, financing request, or application workflow.

Important disclaimer

This publication is general educational and market information. It is not legal, tax, accounting, investment, lending, zoning, title, appraisal, escrow, or regulatory advice. Requirements change and may vary by applicant, premises, license series, county, municipality, and transaction. Confirm current requirements with the Florida Division of Alcoholic Beverages and Tobacco (ABT), other agencies, and your own qualified advisers before acting.



GUIDE MAP

What is inside

Read front to back, or jump directly to the path that matches your role.

Section	Topic	What you will learn
00	FLLM platform overview	Six connected roles and the live website
01	Florida's quota system	Why supply is county-specific and limited
02	Choose the right license	Privileges, operating examples, and food-sales percentage requirements
03	How to obtain the right privileges	License selection, business and tax clearances, purchase, application, or drawing
04	Broker-assisted or self-directed?	Tradeoffs plus the two buyer paths on FLLM
05	Buyer roadmap	Search, diligence, contract, application, and closing
06	Seller roadmap	Prepare, price, market, negotiate, and transfer
07	Pricing, valuation, and heat maps	County-by-county market value and FLLM market data
08	Financing and investment capital	Private lenders, commercial banks, self-directed IRAs, FLLM introductions, and investment pathways
09	DABT, applications, laws, and forms	Laws page, ABT-6002, fingerprints, background review, and the drawing
10	How FLLM and its directories can assist	Data, listings, brokerage, valuation, lawyers, resources, and education
11	Checklists, glossary, and resources	Action lists, definitions, questions, and official links

00 • ONE CONNECTED PLATFORM

What Florida Liquor License Market is

FLLM is more than a listings page. It connects market information, transaction services, and practical licensing resources in one Florida-focused platform.



The live FLLM website gives buyers, sellers, lenders, investors, and applicants a common starting point.

Market data website — county inventory, disclosed asking prices, market research, historical context, and price-oriented tools.

Valuation and appraisal service — preliminary market information, broker pricing work, and formal quota-license appraisal assignments where appropriate.

Florida liquor-license platform — statewide listings, county pages, license-type guidance, financing resources, forms, and transaction pathways.

Self-directed listing service — sellers or independent brokers can obtain marketplace exposure while retaining control of communications and the transaction.

Professional buyer or seller broker service — represented clients can engage FLLM for sourcing, pricing strategy, confidential marketing, communications, negotiation, and transaction coordination under a written agreement.

Educational site — plain-language explanations of quota licenses, 4COP and 3PS series, DABT/ABT procedures, forms, statutes, due diligence, financing, and valuation.

THE DISTINCTION MATTERS

Using FLLM's public information or self-directed marketplace does not automatically create brokerage representation. Representation begins only through a separate written agreement defining the client, scope, and compensation.

01 • MARKET FOUNDATION

How Florida's quota system works

Scarcity is created by statute, but market value is created by county-level supply and demand.

Florida limits the number of full-liquor quota licenses issued in each county. Under section 561.20, Florida Statutes, the general ceiling is one quota license for each 7,500 county residents, with statutory exceptions and special-license categories.

WHY THIS MATTERS

A quota license is not a statewide commodity. The relevant market is usually the county, the license series, the available supply, and the specific transaction terms.

Four practical consequences

01 County-specific value

A 4COP quota license in one county may trade very differently from the same series in another county.

02 Transferable supply

Existing quota licenses may be bought and transferred to qualified applicants, subject to ABT approval and other requirements.

03 Population-driven additions

New quota licenses may become available when county population increases, then are allocated through the statutory drawing process.

04 Exceptions are not interchangeable

Special restaurant, hotel, club, airport, and other licenses can carry different qualification and location restrictions; they should not be valued like a freely transferable quota license.

Is Florida one of “18 quota states”?

Industry participants often describe Florida as one of roughly 18 states with quota, capped, or otherwise limited retail liquor-license systems. There is no single federal definition or official nationwide master list, so the exact count can vary depending on which license classes and restrictions are included. The important point is that Florida clearly uses a statutory county-population quota for the affected full-liquor licenses.

OFFICIAL SOURCE § 561.20, Fla. Stat. (2026); Florida DBPR, Quota Licenses & Drawings.

02 • PRIVILEGES FIRST

Choose the license that matches the business

Start with what will be sold, where it will be consumed, and whether the operation can satisfy special-license criteria.

Common path	Typical privileges	Best fit	Key caution
4COP quota series	Beer, wine, and spirits; on-premises consumption and authorized package sales, subject to law	Bars, lounges, restaurants, hospitality concepts needing full-liquor flexibility	Quota license; confirm exact series, county, zoning, premises, and transfer status
3PS quota	Package sales of beer, wine, and spirits for off-premises consumption	Liquor stores and package-sales concepts	Does not authorize on-premises consumption
2COP	Beer and wine for consumption on premises and authorized package sales	Concepts that do not need distilled spirits	Not a substitute when cocktails or spirits are central
SFS / special restaurant	Beer, wine, and spirits for qualifying food-service operations	Restaurants meeting statutory size, seating, and revenue tests	Qualification and ongoing food-revenue rules; generally tied to the qualifying operation/premises

A 3PS-to-4COP change may be possible

A transferable 3PS quota license may be eligible for a change to the applicable 4COP quota series through ABT's change-in-series or type process. Approval is not automatic. Confirm eligibility, zoning, a qualifying premises, required filings, fees, and all other state and local requirements before buying a 3PS in reliance on future 4COP privileges.

DECISION RULE

Do not buy the label. Buy the privileges and transfer characteristics that the operating plan actually requires—after verification.

OFFICIAL SOURCE Florida DBPR, Licenses and Permits for Alcoholic Beverages (updated 2025); DBPR Change of Location / Change in Series or Type checklist.

02A • OPERATING ENVIRONMENTS

Match the license to the business people will actually enter

Restaurants, bars, lounges, nightclubs, and package stores can require different privileges and may follow different licensing paths.



Illustrative Florida hospitality environments: a full-service restaurant, cocktail bar, and nightclub.

Operating model	Common licensing direction	Questions to resolve first
Full-service restaurant	A qualifying special restaurant license may be available; otherwise a quota 4COP-family license may be needed for full-liquor privileges.	Seating, square footage, food-service revenue, zoning, and continuing qualification.
Bar or cocktail lounge	Often requires a quota 4COP-family license for full-liquor consumption on premises.	County, series, premises approval, hours, distance rules, entertainment, and package-sale plans.
Nightclub	Often uses a quota 4COP-family license, subject to the exact series and approved premises.	Occupancy, zoning, security, late-hours rules, entertainment, and local approvals.
Liquor store	A 3PS-family quota license generally supports package sales for off-premises consumption.	County, package-only use, zoning, transfer status, inventory, and store premises.

VISUAL EXAMPLES ARE NOT CLASSIFICATIONS

The room design does not determine the license. The privileges, applicant, premises, county, operating facts, and current DABT rules control.

02B • REVENUE REQUIREMENTS

Which licenses require food sales?

The 51% test belongs to qualifying restaurant and caterer exceptions - not to standard quota 3PS or 4COP licenses.

License path	Minimum food + nonalcoholic share	Alcohol share under this test	Practical meaning
1APS / 2APS	None	No percentage test	Beer or beer-and-wine package privileges; product and location rules still apply.
1COP / 2COP	None	No percentage test	Beer or beer-and-wine COP privileges; a 2COP does not authorize spirits.
3PS quota family	None	No percentage test	A liquor or package store may operate without food sales.
4COP quota family	None	No percentage test	A standard quota bar or nightclub is not required by this license category to generate food sales.
4COP-SFS / SRX restaurant	At least 51%	No more than 49%	Measured from gross food-and-beverage revenue under the statutory operating periods; premises, seating, and meal-service tests also apply.
13CT caterer	At least 51%	No more than 49%	The statutory test applies to gross food-and-beverage revenue at each catered event.
Special-act / other specialty	Varies	Varies	Read the governing statute, special act, and current DBPR conditions for the exact license.

THE IMPORTANT COMPARISON

A standard 3PS or quota 4COP does not carry a minimum food-sales requirement. A qualifying 4COP-SFS restaurant generally must produce at least 51% of gross food-and-beverage revenue from food and nonalcoholic beverages, leaving no more than 49% under that revenue test for alcoholic beverages.

The chart addresses the alcoholic-beverage license percentage test. Zoning, food-service permits, local rules, premises restrictions, and other approvals may still apply.

SFS is the current DBPR modifier for Special Food Service. DBPR also uses SRX in its restaurant FAQ. SFX is not a standard current DBPR license abbreviation; verify the actual series and modifier if that term appears.

OFFICIAL SOURCE Florida DBPR, Licenses and Permits for Alcoholic Beverages (updated 2025) and Alcoholic Beverages & Tobacco FAQs; § 561.20(2)(a)4.-5., Fla. Stat. (2026).

03 • ACQUISITION STRATEGY

Three ways to obtain the needed privileges

Path	Advantages	Tradeoffs	Best when
Buy an existing quota license	Potentially faster access; known county and series; negotiated commercial terms	Market price, diligence, contract, transfer approval, and closing coordination	Timing and operational certainty matter
Enter the annual quota drawing	Low entry fee relative to market value; possible access to newly available supply	No guarantee of selection; limited counties; post-selection deadlines and qualification requirements	The applicant can tolerate uncertainty and wait
Apply for non-quota or special authority	No quota purchase price if the operation genuinely qualifies	Premises and operating-model restrictions; continuing qualification obligations	The business model fits the statutory exception or beer/wine privileges

Do not choose on acquisition price alone

A cheaper license can be expensive if it cannot support the intended use.

A special license can be valuable operationally but may not carry the same mobility or resale characteristics as a quota license.

Winning a drawing creates an opportunity to apply; it is not an immediate operating license and does not replace qualification review.

A purchase contract should allocate the risk that approval, zoning, financing, or another closing condition is not satisfied.

FIRST FLLM CONVERSATION

Bring the county, intended concept, target opening date, desired privileges, budget, and whether you already control a premises. Those six facts usually determine the next useful step.

03A • HOW TO BUY

How to buy a Florida liquor license

The correct path begins with the privileges—not with a generic search for “a liquor license.”

Likely path	What it generally permits	How it is obtained
2APS	Beer and wine in sealed containers for off-premises consumption.	Apply for an original non-quota license through DBPR/DABT, generally using ABT-6001.
2COP	Beer and wine by the drink for on-premises consumption; sealed-container sales may be allowed subject to law and local ordinance.	Apply for an original non-quota license through DBPR/DABT, generally using ABT-6001.
4COP-SFS	Beer, wine, and spirits for a qualifying bona fide food-service establishment.	Apply under the special food-service path. General-law criteria include 2,000 square feet of service area, capacity and physical seating for 120, and the required food/nonalcoholic revenue percentage; confirm any special-act rules.
3PS quota	Beer, wine, and spirits in sealed containers for off-premises consumption.	Purchase and transfer an existing county quota license, or obtain the opportunity to apply through the annual drawing.
4COP quota	Beer, wine, and spirits by the drink or in sealed containers for consumption on or off the licensed premises, subject to the exact series and applicable law.	Purchase and transfer an existing county quota license, or obtain the opportunity to apply through the annual drawing.

TWO FUNDAMENTALLY DIFFERENT ROUTES

A 2APS, 2COP, or qualifying 4COP-SFS is generally pursued as an original application without buying a privately held quota license. A 3PS or 4COP quota license is county-limited and is generally acquired by purchasing and transferring an existing license or by receiving an opportunity to apply through the quota drawing.

OFFICIAL SOURCE Florida DBPR/DABT, Licenses and Permits for Alcoholic Beverages (updated 2025); 2APS, 2COP, and 4COP checklists; § 561.20, Fla. Stat. (2026).

03B • APPLICATION PATH

From business setup to state approval

The commercial deal and the government application are connected—but they are not the same transaction.

01 Choose the right privileges

Identify the county and city, the business model, the beverages to be sold, where they will be consumed, package-sale needs, and whether the premises can satisfy a special-license path. Florida limits affected quota licenses by county population at generally one per 7,500 residents.

02 Establish the applicant and clearances

Register the business entity with the Florida Division of Corporations if applicable; obtain an EIN where required; establish rights to the premises; address zoning, health, and local approvals; and register the named applicant for Florida sales and use tax. Identify owners and interested parties and complete fingerprints, background disclosures, and other supporting items when required.

03 Apply, purchase, or enter the drawing

For an original non-quota or qualifying special license, file through the current DBPR/DABT application path. For an existing quota license, locate a seller directly or through FLLM, negotiate a contract with appropriate contingencies, complete diligence, and submit the transfer package—generally ABT-6002. A drawing selection is only an opportunity to apply and qualify; it is not immediate authority to sell alcohol.

WHAT TO TELL FLLM

Provide the county and city, restaurant/bar/store concept, desired privileges, budget, target opening date, premises status, and whether you prefer self-directed marketplace access or professional buyer representation. FLLM can help identify the likely route, show available licenses, provide market context, and organize relevant resources; only DBPR/DABT can approve or issue the license.

OFFICIAL SOURCE Florida DBPR/DABT, Transfer of Ownership checklist; Florida Department of Revenue, Alcoholic Beverage License Approvals; §§ 561.19–561.20, Fla. Stat. (2026).

04 • REPRESENTATION CHOICE

Broker-assisted or self-directed?

Either route can work. The right choice depends on experience, time, access to inventory, and tolerance for transaction risk.

Issue	Broker-assisted route	Self-directed route
Inventory / buyer reach	Professional network, marketplace exposure, and confidential outreach	You source counterparties and verify their authority yourself
Pricing	Market context, positioning, and negotiation support	You develop your own comparable evidence and strategy
Process	One coordinator can help sequence diligence, contract milestones, financing, filing, and closing	You manage every participant, deadline, and deliverable
Cost	Commission or agreed professional fee	Lower direct intermediary cost, but more internal time and outside-adviser coordination
Risk control	Experienced issue spotting and referral to qualified professionals	Risk depends heavily on your knowledge and the team you assemble
Best fit	First-time participants, confidential searches, complex structures, thin markets, or compressed timing	Experienced parties with an identified counterparty and strong legal, regulatory, and closing support

A BROKER IS NOT THE REGULATOR—OR YOUR LAWYER

Broker assistance does not replace ABT approval, local zoning review, legal advice, tax advice, title/lien work, or lender underwriting. Confirm the scope and compensation in writing.

For applicants

Application support can help organize information, identify the correct official filing path, and keep a checklist moving. The applicant remains responsible for accurate disclosures and qualification; only ABT can approve and issue the license.

04A • BUYER WEBSITE PATH

Locate a license directly on the FLLM listings page

A buyer who does not need representation can search the public marketplace, compare county inventory, and open an individual listing for more information.



Full desktop view of FLLM's listings page: statewide inventory, filters, heat-map access, and individual listing cards.

01

Filter the market

Choose availability, county, license type, and price range; use the heat map when the target county is still being evaluated.

02

Open and compare

Review the exact county, series, asking price, availability, source information, listing notes, and inquiry path.

03

Verify before committing

Confirm the DABT record, owner, status, liens, transfer requirements, premises issues, and signed transaction terms.

MARKETPLACE PATH

A public listing is a discovery tool—not proof of title, value, transferability, or regulatory approval. Self-directed buyers remain responsible for diligence and professional advisers.

04B • PROFESSIONAL REPRESENTATION

Engage FLLM for buyer or seller brokerage services

Brokerage is the higher-support path for clients who want defined professional assistance rather than marketplace access alone.



FLLM's brokerage-services page separates represented work from self-directed marketplace access.

For a represented buyer

- Define the county, correct license series, intended use, budget, premises status, and timing.
- Search listed and, where included in the engagement, off-market or network opportunities.
- Compare disclosed asking prices and other relevant county-level market evidence.
- Coordinate communications, business-term negotiation, diligence milestones, financing, and transfer preparation within the agreed scope.

For a represented seller

- Develop a pricing and marketing strategy, control confidential information, screen inquiries, and negotiate business terms.
- Coordinate the seller's license information, payoff/release plan, buyer diligence, transfer preparation, and closing milestones.

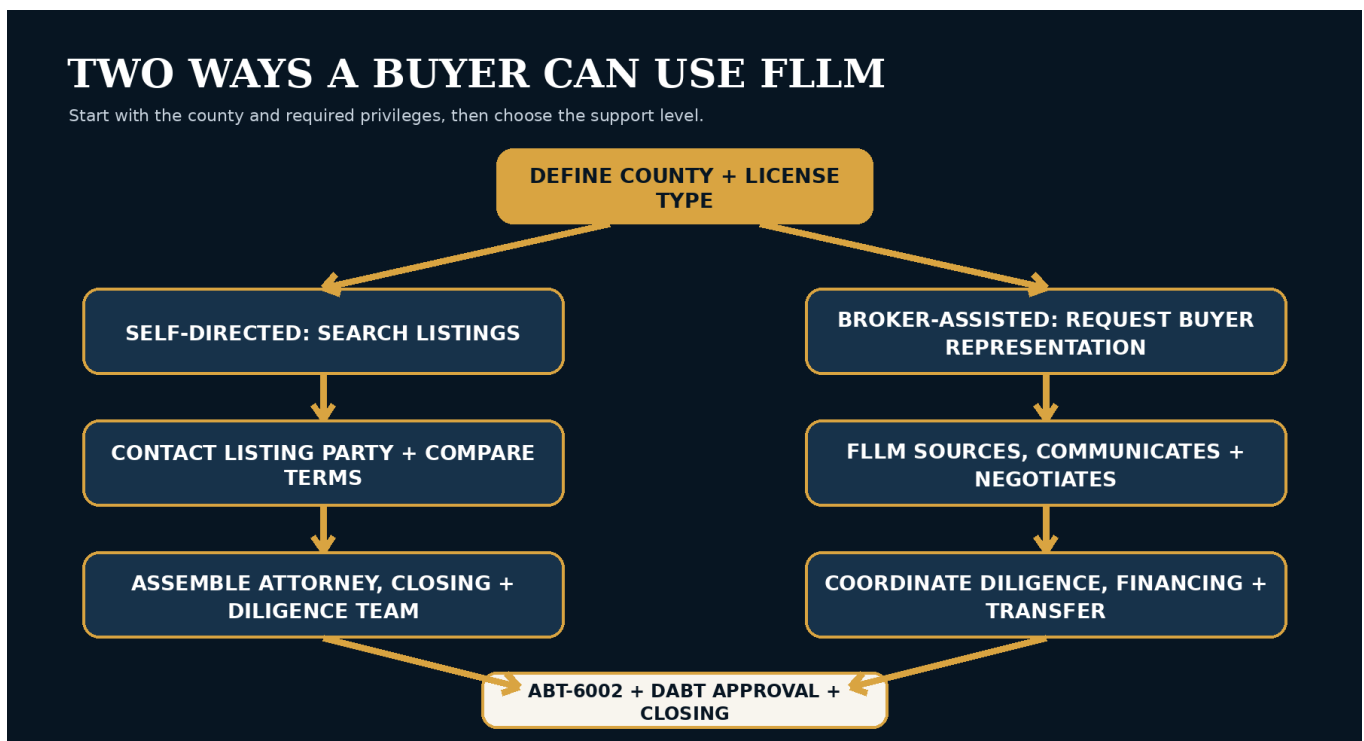
WRITTEN ENGAGEMENT REQUIRED

The agreement controls who FLLM represents, the services included, confidentiality, exclusivity if any, compensation, and the responsibilities retained by the client and outside professionals.

04C • BUYER PATHWAYS

Two ways to move from FLLM research to a transaction

The public marketplace and professional brokerage path can begin at the same website, but the service relationship and responsibilities are different.



Illustrated buyer pathway: self-directed marketplace use and broker-assisted representation converge at diligence, DABT approval, and closing.

Self-directed buyers use listings, county data, forms, calculators, the Laws page, and professional directories while managing their own communications and transaction team.

Represented buyers engage FLLM under a written agreement for defined sourcing, communications, pricing support, negotiation, and coordination services.

SAME WEBSITE, DIFFERENT RELATIONSHIP

Using FLLM information or contacting a public listing does not create brokerage representation. Representation begins only through an accepted written agreement.

04D • PROFESSIONAL TEAM

Know which adviser is responsible for which risk

A broker, transaction attorney, valuation professional, lender, closing professional, and regulator perform different functions.



Illustrative transaction conference: buyer, broker, and attorney reviewing a license-style document and transaction checklist. The depicted document is not an official form.

Participant	Primary contribution	Important boundary
Broker	Inventory access, pricing context, communications, negotiation, and coordination within the engagement.	Does not replace legal advice, appraisal scope, lien work, or DABT approval.
Transaction attorney	Contract terms, entity authority, due diligence, lien and tax issues, escrow/closing structure, and legal risk.	Confirm actual beverage-law and transaction experience; engagement terms control.
Valuation / appraisal professional	Defined market analysis or formal appraisal for an identified purpose and effective date.	An asking price, heat map, or broker opinion is not automatically a formal appraisal.
DABT and other agencies	Applicant qualification, premises and filing review, license issuance, and regulatory records.	Government agencies do not negotiate the private transaction or protect either party's commercial position.

05 • BUYER ROADMAP

From operating plan to approved transfer

01	Define the use List the beverages, service model, package sales, hours, and intended premises.
02	Choose county and series Confirm that the license privileges align with the operating plan and local rules.
03	Set the total budget Include purchase price, deposits, government fees, professional fees, financing costs, improvements, and working capital.
04	Search the market Compare inventory, asking terms, status, seller authority, and whether business or real estate assets are included.
05	Verify the record Check the ABT record, owner name, license number, county, series, and current status.
06	Negotiate a protected agreement Use written terms covering price, escrow, approvals, diligence, financing, default, and closing.
07	Complete diligence Investigate liens, taxes, litigation, entity authority, zoning, premises rights, and transfer eligibility.
08	Arrange funding Match cash, lender, or seller-financing conditions to the expected application and closing timeline.
09	File the correct application Use current ABT instructions and provide all required applicant and premises information.
10	Coordinate closing and activation Deliver funds and releases only under the agreed closing conditions; preserve proof of transfer and approval.



05A • BUYER DILIGENCE

Verify before you rely

A listing, screenshot, or seller statement is a starting point—not the diligence record.

Workstream	Confirm	Evidence to retain
License identity	License number, series/type, county, status, premises address, and named licensee	Current ABT lookup and official correspondence
Seller authority	Entity good standing and authority of the signer	Sunbiz record, resolutions/consents, identification
Liens and claims	Recorded ABT interests plus other relevant searches	ABT lien results, UCC, judgment, tax, and payoff/release documents as applicable
Tax matters	DOR registration/approval and seller clearance obligations relevant to the deal	DOR approval or clearance documentation
Premises	Lease or ownership rights, zoning, distance rules, occupancy, health/sanitary approvals	Lease/deed, zoning confirmation, plans, certificates
Contract	Contingencies, deadlines, deposit treatment, allocation of fees, closing documents, failure remedies	Executed agreement and written amendments
Funding	Final approval, collateral, equity, fees, closing conditions	Commitment/term documents and closing statement

HIGH-RISK SHORTCUT

Do not release the purchase price solely because an application was filed or a temporary license was issued. Follow the negotiated escrow and closing conditions, and obtain professional advice on the transaction structure.

OFFICIAL SOURCE §§ 561.17, 561.32, 561.65, Fla. Stat. (2026); Florida DOR, Alcoholic Beverage License Approvals.

05B • DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Contract, escrow, application, and closing

The four tracks should move together

01	Commercial agreement Defines the license interest, price, deposit, included assets, representations, contingencies, and remedies.
02	Regulatory filing Provides ABT with the applicant, ownership, premises, and transaction information required for review.
03	Funding and collateral Sets lender conditions, equity requirements, payoffs, lien filings, and disbursement instructions.
04	Closing delivery Coordinates funds, transfer documents, releases, possession, and post-closing obligations.

Contract points to discuss with counsel

Exact license number, county, series, and whether any business, inventory, lease, or real estate is included.

Deposit holder, refund conditions, approval contingency, diligence period, financing contingency, and outside closing date.

Responsibility for government fees, transfer taxes or penalties, broker fees, legal fees, payoffs, and cure costs.

Seller operation and preservation duties before closing; buyer access to records and premises.

What happens if a temporary license is available but final approval is delayed or denied.

TEMPORARY AUTHORITY

Florida law provides temporary-license mechanisms for qualifying, properly completed transfer, location-change, and series/type applications. Availability and use depend on the statute and the facts; confirm the current process with ABT.

OFFICIAL SOURCE § 561.331, Fla. Stat. (2026); DBPR Transfer of Ownership checklist.

06 • SELLER ROADMAP

Prepare the license before marketing it

01	Confirm the record Verify named owner, license number, series, county, status, location, and renewal posture.
02	Map all interests Identify ABT-recorded liens, lender rights, tax issues, judgments, UCC filings, and any required releases.
03	Define what is for sale License only, business assets, inventory, lease rights, real estate, or a combination.
04	Establish pricing evidence Use current county inventory, recent verified transactions where available, series, status, and deal terms.
05	Choose marketing exposure Public listing, confidential outreach, broker network, or direct buyer strategy.
06	Screen the buyer Review identity, intended use, proof of funds or financing readiness, timeline, and contingencies.
07	Negotiate written terms Protect confidentiality, deposit handling, diligence scope, operating duties, and closing conditions.
08	Prepare the transfer file Organize entity approvals, lien payoffs/releases, tax items, application cooperation, and closing deliverables.
09	Coordinate closing Do not assume signing an application transfers ownership; follow the contract, escrow instructions, and approval process.

06A • SELLER PREPARATION

Make the opportunity easier to trust —and easier to close

A complete seller packet can include

- Current license record and clear identification of the license interest being offered.
- Entity documents and signer authority.
- ABT lien information and a payoff/release plan for each recorded interest.
- Status of any premises, lease, business assets, inventory, or real estate included in the transaction.
- Known regulatory, tax, litigation, renewal, or operational issues that could affect timing or transfer.
- A realistic availability date and cooperation plan for buyer diligence and the application.

Public listing or confidential process?

Approach	Useful when	Watch for
Public marketplace listing	Maximum visibility and inbound demand are priorities	Sensitive business information should be separated from public-facing facts
Confidential broker outreach	Owner, employees, landlords, or counterparties should not learn of a potential sale prematurely	Use controlled disclosures and qualified-buyer screening
Direct / off-market negotiation	A credible buyer is already identified	Limited price discovery and concentration risk if the buyer does not perform

SELLER LEVERAGE

Clean documentation, credible pricing support, and a defined release plan can matter as much as the asking price. Unresolved title or lien issues often become last-minute negotiating pressure.

07 • MARKET VALUE

What drives quota-license pricing?

Asking prices are visible. Closed terms, condition, timing, and transfer characteristics are what make comparisons meaningful.

Value driver	Why it matters
County supply and demand	Quota availability, active buyers, restaurant/bar growth, and local transaction volume shape the market.
License series and privileges	3PS and 4COP quota interests serve different operating models and can have different demand.
Status and transfer readiness	Active, inactive/escrow, delinquent, encumbered, or issue-affected licenses may not be directly comparable.
Location and premises rights	A license may be offered separately from—or together with—a lease, operating business, or real estate.
Deal terms	Cash price, seller financing, contingencies, closing period, assumed obligations, and included assets affect economics.
Evidence quality	A current verified closing is generally more informative than an old listing or an unsupported asking price.

Three different value products

Product	Use
Marketplace opinion / preliminary range	Early planning, listing discussion, search budget, or financing conversation; not a formal appraisal.
Broker pricing analysis	Marketing and negotiation strategy using available market evidence and transaction context.
Formal appraisal	A documented valuation assignment with defined scope, effective date, assumptions, methodology, and intended use—often for lender, litigation, estate, or other formal review.

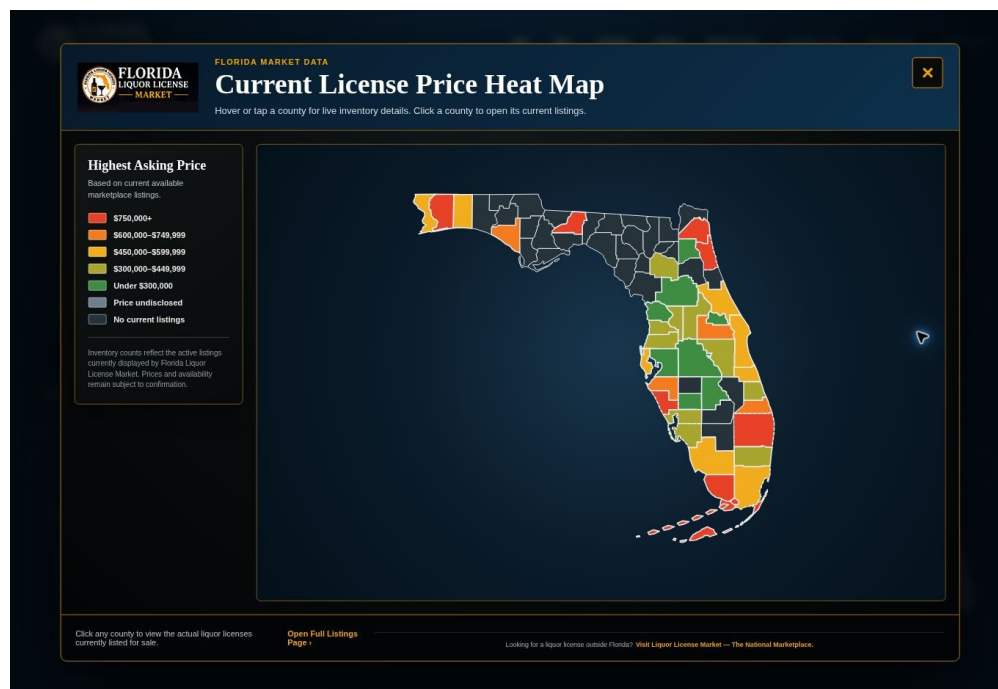
DO NOT MIX ASSETS

A liquor license price should not silently absorb goodwill, furniture, inventory, a below-market lease, or real estate. Identify each component and its consideration.

07A • FLLM MARKET INTELLIGENCE

Use the heat map to understand county-level asking prices

The heat map is a visual entry point into current marketplace inventory—not a substitute for a valuation or a verified closed-sale database.



Example: FLLM Current License Price Heat Map, colored by the highest disclosed asking price among available marketplace listings.

Each county color reflects the asking-price band generated from current FLLM marketplace listings. Counties with no current listings and listings without disclosed prices are identified separately. A user can move from the map to actual county inventory and then to individual license pages. The Research Hub and Market Index add inventory counts, county comparisons, source transparency, and downloadable market data.

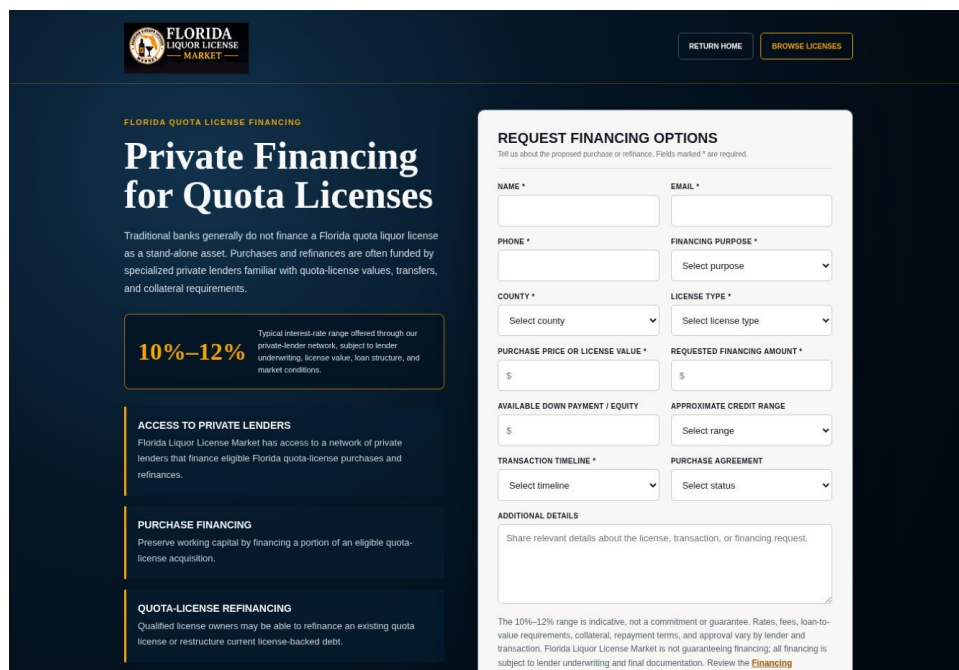
INTERPRET CAREFULLY

A heat-map color is not an appraisal conclusion. Asking prices can differ from closed prices, and a county's highest ask may represent a single seller, unusual terms, a different license series, or an outlier. Use the underlying listings and a defined valuation scope before relying on the result.

08 • CAPITAL PLAN

Choose the capital source that fits the transaction

FLLM helps borrowers organize a financing request and reach potentially relevant capital sources; each source independently decides whether and how it will lend.



The screenshot shows the 'Private Financing for Quota Licenses' page on the Florida Liquor License Market website. The page features a dark blue header with the FLLM logo and navigation links. The main content area is divided into two columns. The left column contains a title, a paragraph about traditional banks, a highlighted interest rate range of 10%–12%, and three sections: 'ACCESS TO PRIVATE LENDERS', 'PURCHASE FINANCING', and 'QUOTA-LICENSE REFINANCING'. The right column contains a 'REQUEST FINANCING OPTIONS' form with fields for Name, Email, Phone, Financing Purpose, County, License Type, Purchase Price or License Value, Requested Financing Amount, Available Down Payment / Equity, Approximate Credit Range, Transaction Timeline, and Purchase Agreement. There is also a section for 'ADDITIONAL DETAILS' with a text area for sharing relevant details.

FLLM borrower-financing page: a confidential request captures the county, license type, value, requested amount, equity, credit range, timing, and transaction status.

A stand-alone quota-license loan is often evaluated differently from a loan secured by an operating restaurant, bar, nightclub, liquor store, real estate, equipment, or broader business cash flow.

FLLM can organize the transaction facts, identify missing information, provide county and license-market context, and make introductions to potentially suitable lending sources.

FLLM has relationships and develops referral channels with specialized private lenders, individual and self-directed IRA lenders, commercial-bank contacts, specialty finance sources, and other capital partners.

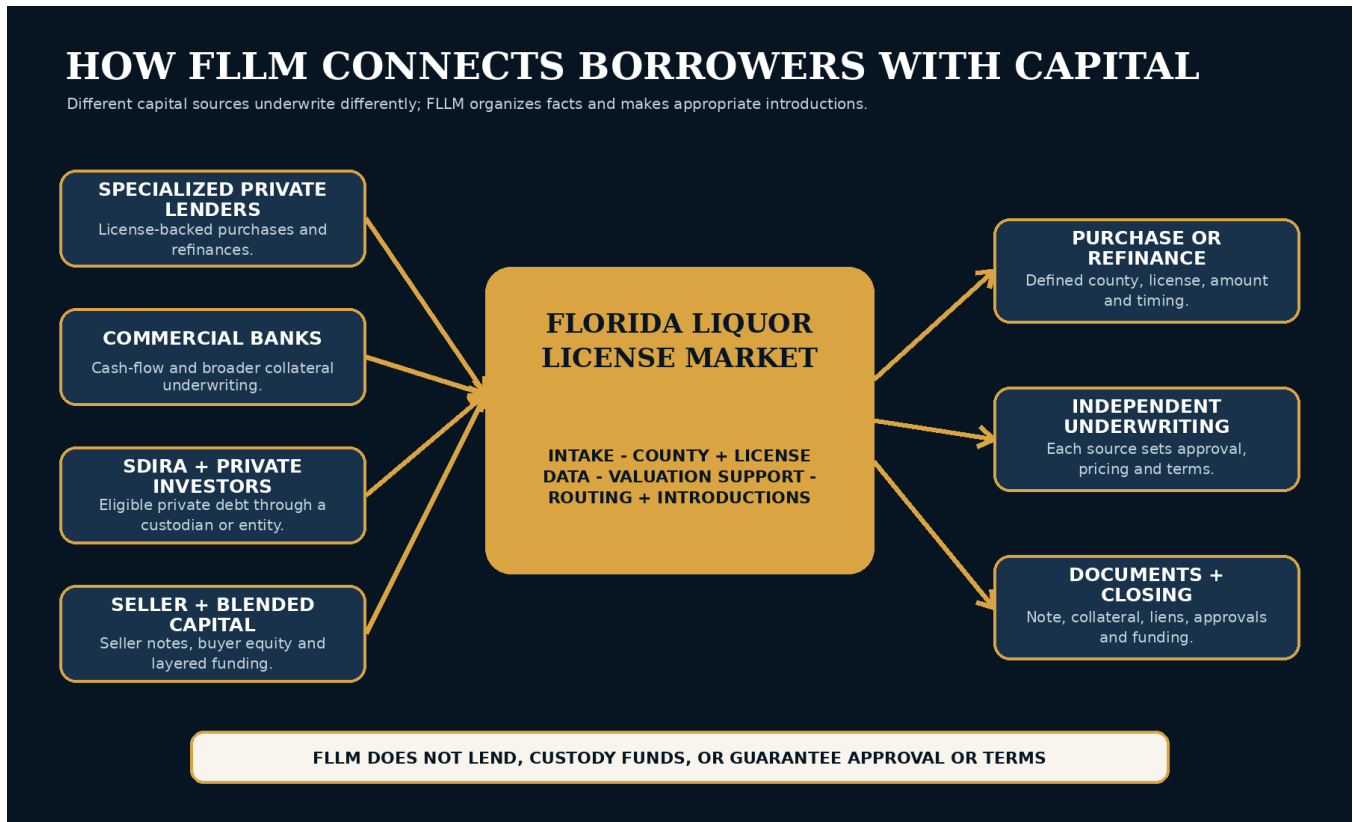
A relationship or introduction is not an endorsement, commitment, fiduciary relationship, or assurance that the lender will approve the request or accept a particular valuation.

BEGIN WITH A COMPLETE REQUEST

Provide the county, exact license series, purchase or refinance purpose, requested amount, available equity, transaction agreement status, timing, intended use, borrower information, and any additional business or real-estate collateral.

08A • CAPITAL CONNECTIONS

How FLLM connects a borrower with potential capital



Capital-routing diagram: FLLM helps organize and route a transaction, while every lender retains its own underwriting, documentation, pricing, and approval authority.

FLLM's role may include intake, market-data support, valuation or appraisal work under a separate engagement, preparation of a lender-ready fact pattern, and introductions to one or more potentially relevant sources.

The lender's role includes credit review, collateral analysis, loan-to-value limits, repayment analysis, guarantees, pricing, fees, conditions, documentation, and the final funding decision.

The borrower and advisers remain responsible for accurate disclosures, transaction documents, legal and tax review, lien and title work, DABT requirements, and compliance with closing conditions.

SEPARATE SERVICES

A financing introduction does not automatically include brokerage, appraisal, legal work, IRA administration, closing, or loan servicing. The written agreement for each selected service controls scope and fees.

08B • LENDER TYPES

Private lenders, commercial banks, and blended structures

No single source is best for every transaction. The strongest structure matches the asset package, repayment source, timing, and borrower profile.

Capital source	Common fit	What usually matters
Specialized private lender	Standalone quota-license purchase or refinance; faster or more flexible situations	County value, license series, requested leverage, equity, borrower credit, note terms, guarantees, lien priority, and exit strategy
Individual / SDIRA private lender	Privately negotiated note for an unrelated borrower, using eligible personal, entity, or retirement-account capital	Independent underwriting, custodian acceptance when applicable, prohibited-transaction review, documentation, repayment risk, and servicing
Commercial bank	Operating-business acquisition or refinance supported by cash flow and a broader collateral package	Historical and projected cash flow, global debt service, guarantors, liquidity, business assets, real estate, appraisal requirements, covenants, and bank policy
Seller financing	Part of the price is carried by the seller to bridge an equity or valuation gap	Down payment, payment schedule, maturity, security, lien priority, subordination, default remedies, and seller credit risk
Blended structure	Buyer equity plus bank or private senior debt, seller carry, or another junior source	Intercreditor terms, combined debt burden, lien priority, standstill/subordination terms, and coordinated closing conditions

How commercial-bank financing differs

Many banks are more comfortable when repayment comes from a demonstrated operating business and the lender receives more than a liquor-license interest alone.

A bank may require borrower and guarantor financial statements, tax returns, business projections, debt-service support, appraisals, entity documents, insurance, deposits, and additional collateral.

Where a transaction fits bank policy, FLLM may help assemble market and license information and introduce the borrower to a commercial-bank contact; the bank controls underwriting and acceptance of any report.

DO NOT COMPARE RATE ALONE

Compare total fees, amortization, balloon maturity, prepayment terms, guarantees, collateral, lien priority, closing speed, covenants, default remedies, and the consequences if DABT approval or another condition is delayed.

08C • SELF-DIRECTED IRA CAPITAL

Using a self-directed IRA for a private license-backed loan

Some custodians permit an eligible IRA to hold private debt. The IRA—not the owner personally—is the lender, and the custodian must accept and administer the investment.



FLLM Self-Directed IRA Lending page: educational guidance, opportunity access, and clearly limited \$495 administrative setup assistance.

01

Choose a qualified custodian or trustee

The customer selects a custodian that permits the proposed private-debt investment. FLLM is not the custodian and does not hold retirement funds.

02

Open and fund the account correctly

Transfers or rollovers are handled by the existing provider and the receiving custodian under their procedures; the customer approves all elections and signs all documents.

03

Review the proposed borrower and loan

Confirm the borrower is unrelated, investigate direct and indirect prohibited-transaction concerns, and independently underwrite the license, repayment source, liens, value, terms, and remedies.

04

Title, fund, and pay through the IRA

The custodian uses its required account titling and funding process. Principal and interest payments return to the IRA rather than to the IRA owner personally.

08C2 • IRA SETUP ASSISTANCE

What FLLM's \$495 administrative service includes

FLLM can help organize the account-opening and transfer process while the customer and selected custodian retain every decision, signature, compliance determination, and movement of funds.

FLLM IRA SETUP ASSISTANCE — \$495

For a one-time administrative fee, FLLM can organize account-opening materials, help assemble customer-approved factual documents, coordinate transfer or rollover paperwork with the selected custodian, track missing items and follow-up, and prepare an administrative checklist for a future investment request. FLLM does not select the custodian, make tax elections, move funds, determine eligibility, or provide legal, tax, or investment advice.

FLLM may help with	FLLM does not do
Organize the selected custodian's account-opening checklist and customer-approved factual information	Recommend or select the custodian, trustee, account type, tax treatment, or investment
Help assemble documents requested by the existing provider or receiving custodian	Sign forms, make customer elections, approve the account, or determine whether a rollover or transfer is eligible
Coordinate status questions and track missing administrative items	Receive, hold, transmit, direct, or take custody of retirement funds
Prepare an administrative checklist for a later private-investment request	Underwrite the borrower, approve the investment, determine prohibited-transaction compliance, or replace legal and tax advisers

A clean handoff to the custodian

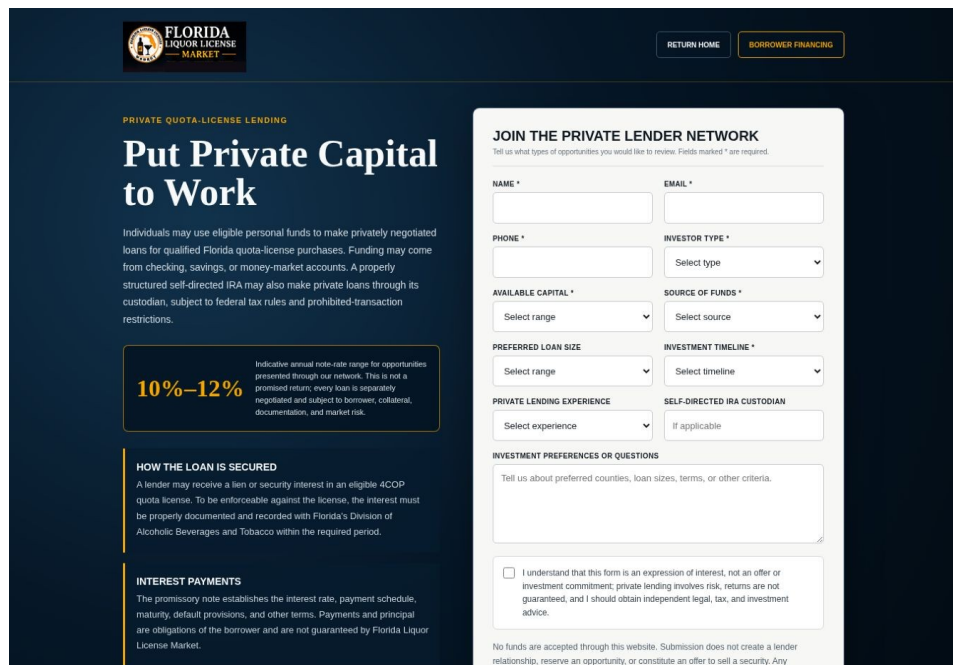
01	Customer chooses the custodian The customer evaluates providers and makes the selection without FLLM directing the choice.
02	FLLM organizes the file FLLM helps collect customer-approved factual information, forms, and outstanding-item questions for the selected providers.
03	Providers process; investment review stays separate The providers control acceptance, transfer or rollover procedures, titling, and movement of funds. Before capital is committed, the customer, custodian, and independent advisers review the proposed investment and documents.

OFFICIAL SOURCE IRS guidance warns that borrowing from an IRA, using it as security, or lending directly or indirectly to a disqualified person can be a prohibited transaction. Nonpublic and owner-controlled assets require particular care. Confirm the current rules with the custodian and independent advisers.

08D • INVESTMENT OPPORTUNITIES

Private capital can participate as a lender—or an investor can pursue direct ownership

FLLM's investment-opportunities page focuses on privately negotiated lending. Direct ownership of a quota license is a different regulated strategy.



PRIVATE QUOTA-LICENSE LENDING

Put Private Capital to Work

Individuals may use eligible personal funds to make privately negotiated loans for qualified Florida quota-license purchases. Funding may come from checking, savings, or money-market accounts. A properly structured self-directed IRA may also make private loans through its custodian, subject to federal tax rules and prohibited-transaction restrictions.

10%–12% Indicative annual rate range for opportunities presented through our network. This is not a promised return; every loan is separately negotiated and subject to borrower, collateral, documentation, and market risk.

HOW THE LOAN IS SECURED
A lender may receive a lien or security interest in an eligible 4COP quota license. To be enforceable against the license, the interest must be properly documented and recorded with Florida's Division of Alcoholic Beverages and Tobacco within the required period.

INTEREST PAYMENTS
The promissory note establishes the interest rate, payment schedule, maturity, default provisions, and other terms. Payments and principal are obligations of the borrower and are not guaranteed by Florida Liquor License Market.

JOIN THE PRIVATE LENDER NETWORK
Tell us what types of opportunities you would like to review. Fields marked * are required.

NAME *
EMAIL *
PHONE *
INVESTOR TYPE *
Select type
AVAILABLE CAPITAL *
Select range
SOURCE OF FUNDS *
Select source
PREFERRED LOAN SIZE *
Select range
INVESTMENT TIMELINE *
Select timeline
PRIVATE LENDING EXPERIENCE *
Select experience
SELF-DIRECTED IRA CUSTODIAN *
If applicable
INVESTMENT PREFERENCES OR QUESTIONS
Tell us about preferred counties, loan sizes, terms, or other criteria.
☐ I understand that this form is an expression of interest, not an offer or investment commitment; private lending involves risk, returns are not guaranteed, and I should obtain independent legal, tax, and investment advice.
No funds are accepted through this website. Submission does not create a lender relationship, reserve an opportunity, or constitute an offer to sell a security. Any

FLLM investment-opportunities page: interested lenders can describe their capital source, preferred loan size, timing, experience, and custodian information.

Private lending through FLLM

Eligible personal, entity, family-office, or self-directed IRA capital may be considered for a privately negotiated loan to an unrelated borrower, subject to independent diligence and documentation.

FLLM can collect lender preferences, present potentially relevant opportunities, facilitate introductions, and provide market or valuation services when separately engaged.

FLLM does not accept investment funds through the website, guarantee repayment or returns, reserve an opportunity, or provide individualized securities, tax, legal, or investment advice.

08D2 • INVESTOR DILIGENCE

What to verify before private capital is committed

Opportunity matching is only the beginning. The investor—or the IRA account acting through its custodian—must independently understand the asset, borrower, documents, repayment plan, and downside scenario.

Private loan	Direct license ownership
Investor owns a note and the contractual or recorded collateral rights described in the loan documents.	Purchaser seeks to own the acquired license interest, subject to qualification, DABT processes, ownership rules, and continuing obligations.
Return depends on borrower payments, loan terms, lien priority, enforceability, collateral value, and recovery after default.	Return depends on acquisition basis, holding costs, license status, market demand, regulatory compliance, and the price and timing of a later disposition.
Due diligence focuses on credit, repayment, leverage, guarantees, collateral, liens, documents, servicing, and enforcement.	Due diligence focuses on eligibility, ownership and transfer, license series and county, liens, taxes, status, renewals, market value, and exit strategy.

Investor file checklist

- Identify the exact license, county, series, status, record owner, transfer or pledge restrictions, and every existing lien or claimed interest.
- Verify purchase price or supported value, borrower equity, requested leverage, additional collateral, guarantees, and the proposed lien priority.
- Review repayment source, operating history when relevant, credit, liquidity, payment schedule, interest, fees, amortization, maturity, balloon, and prepayment terms.
- Use written note, security, recording, closing, servicing, default, enforcement, payoff, and release documents prepared or reviewed by qualified professionals.
- For retirement funds, confirm custodian acceptance, correct titling and payment routing, fees, valuation/reporting duties, and prohibited-transaction analysis before funding.

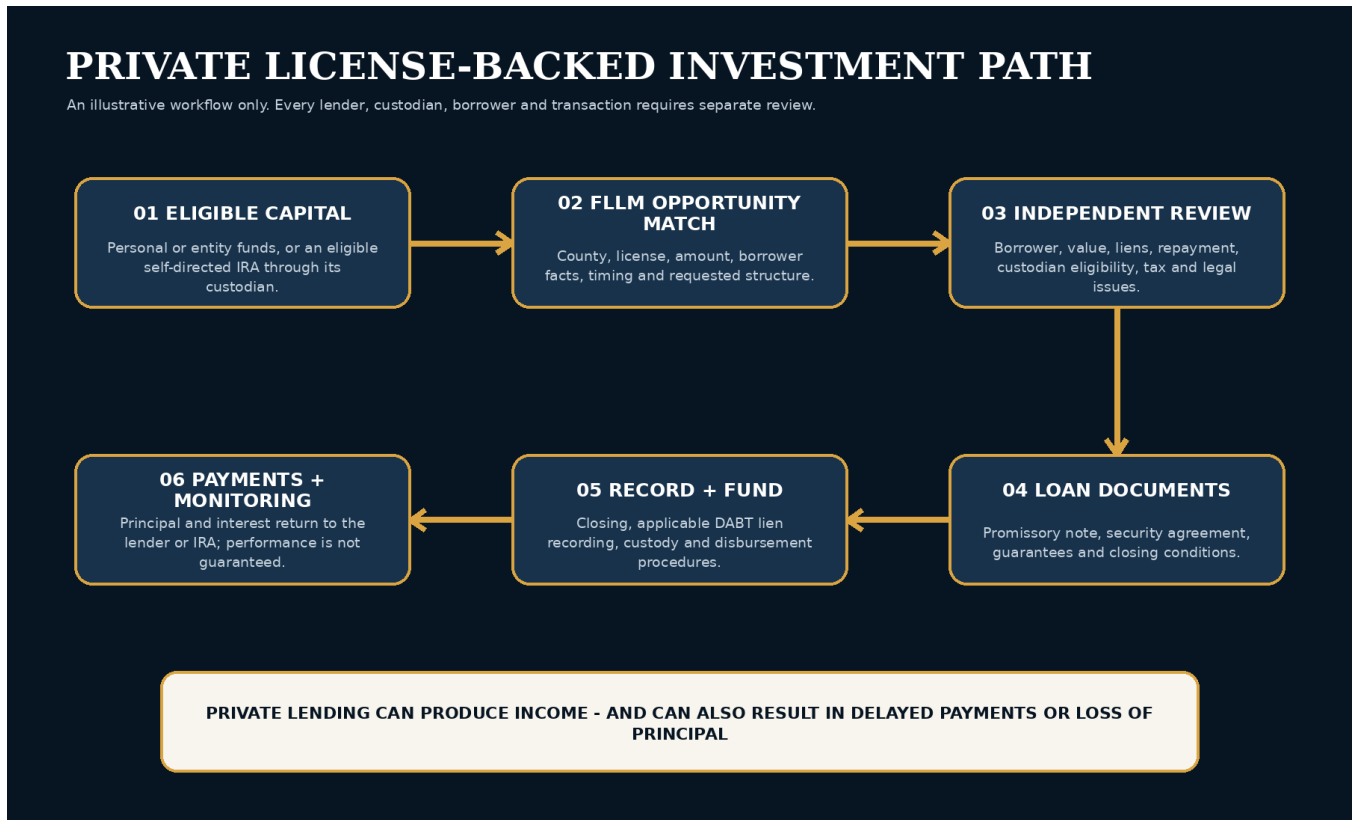
INVESTMENT RISK

Private loans can experience late payments, default, litigation, foreclosure expense, collateral-value decline, regulatory problems, and loss of principal or interest. A recorded lien does not assure repayment or a complete recovery.

OFFICIAL SOURCE § 561.65, Fla. Stat. (2026), addresses mortgagee, lien, and security interests in spirituous alcoholic-beverage licenses. Confirm current recording, priority, enforcement, and qualification requirements with qualified counsel and DABT.

08E • INVESTMENT WORKFLOW

From eligible capital to a private license-backed loan



Illustrative investment path: opportunity matching is followed by independent underwriting, custodian and adviser review, documentation, applicable recording, funding, and ongoing payment monitoring.

Before committing, verify the exact license, county, series, status, record owner, transferability, existing liens, collateral value, requested leverage, borrower equity, repayment capacity, loan terms, guarantees, maturity, and exit strategy.

For IRA capital, add custodian acceptance, account titling, prohibited-transaction analysis, payment routing, valuation and reporting requirements, and all applicable fees.

For every source, use written documents defining the debt, collateral, lien priority, conditions, servicing, default, enforcement, payoff, releases, and closing responsibilities.

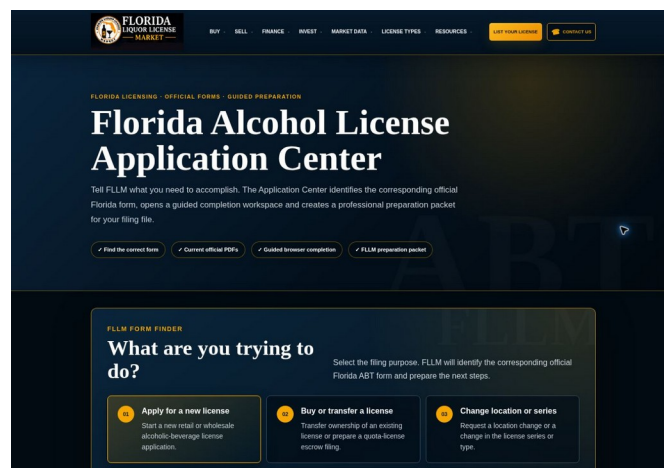
OPPORTUNITY MATCHING—NOT A RECOMMENDATION

FLLM may introduce a potential borrower and lender based on stated criteria. Each participant must make an independent decision and use qualified legal, tax, retirement-account, valuation, and financial professionals as appropriate.

09 • REGULATOR AND RESOURCES

Understand DABT—and use FLLM to find the right official path

Florida's Division of Alcoholic Beverages and Tobacco is commonly referred to as ABT or DABT and operates within the Department of Business and Professional Regulation.



FLLM's Application Center helps users identify the relevant official form and organize a filing-preparation packet.

What DABT does

Administers Florida alcoholic-beverage licensing, applications, transfers, changes, renewals, status, and regulatory records.

Determines applicant qualification and whether the requested license, premises, and filing satisfy current requirements.

Receives fingerprint/background results and may require additional records, certified dispositions, or character-related information when applicable.

What the FLLM Resources pages do

Explain the licensing system, license types, statutes, DABT procedures, due-diligence tools, and common ABT forms in plain language.

Route users to the current official source, provide guided form workspaces, and create organized preparation materials for review and filing.

THE BOUNDARY

FLLM can explain, organize, and prepare. It does not approve the license, replace DABT, or submit government fees on the user's behalf unless a specific written service says otherwise. The official form, instructions, online filing channel, and agency decision control.

09D • LAWS AND RULES

Use the FLLM Laws page as a reference index—then confirm the official source

The Laws page organizes the Florida statutes and ABT administrative rules most frequently encountered in quota-license research and transactions.



FLLM Laws page: statute cards connect readers to the cited Florida law and related FLLM explanations.

Reference area	Why it matters in a transaction
F.S. § 561.20 — quota limitation	Explains the county-population limitation and statutory framework that creates quota scarcity.
F.S. § 561.32 — transfers and interests	Addresses transfer-related requirements, ownership changes, and interests in alcoholic-beverage licenses.
F.S. §§ 561.17, 561.19 and 561.331	Covers applications, the quota drawing, and temporary-license mechanisms.
F.S. § 561.65 and ABT rules	Provides reference points for recorded interests, lien-related research, and agency procedures.

RESEARCH AID, NOT LEGAL ADVICE

FLLM summarizes and links authorities for convenience. Statutes and rules can change, factual application can be disputed, and official government text controls. Consult qualified counsel for transaction-specific legal advice.

09 • REGULATORY PATH

Applying for or transferring a Florida license

The official filing path depends on whether the request is an initial license, transfer of ownership, change of location, change in series/type, or another transaction. Use the current ABT online system, instructions, and checklist for the exact request.

Application workstream	Common items to confirm
Applicant and ownership	Legal name, entity registration, officers/managers, ownership interests, disclosures, fingerprints/background requirements as applicable
License request	Correct class/series, county, transaction type, and whether quota or special qualifications apply
Premises	Right of occupancy, legal description/floor plan as required, zoning, local approvals, distance rules, and sanitary/health documentation where applicable
Tax	Florida Department of Revenue registration and approval requirements
Transaction	Seller/license information, purchase terms, lien releases, change-of-control details, and supporting documents
Fees and timing	Current government fees, method of payment, completeness review, temporary-license eligibility, and response deadlines

WHO APPROVES?

Only the Florida Department of Business and Professional Regulation, Division of Alcoholic Beverages and Tobacco, can approve and issue the state alcoholic-beverage license. Local and other agency approvals may also be required.

Forms change—use the current source

For an existing-license ownership transfer, ABT identifies the transfer-of-ownership application and checklist. For a new license, use the current original/new-license filing path. For a location or series/type change, use that specific checklist. Start at myfloridalicense.com and confirm the exact current filing before preparing documents.

OFFICIAL SOURCE § 561.17, Fla. Stat. (2026); DBPR Forms & Publications; Florida DOR Alcoholic Beverage License Approvals.

09B • TRANSFER FORM

Where ABT-6002 fits in a license purchase

DBPR ABT-6002 is the official transfer-of-ownership application used when ownership of an existing Florida alcoholic-beverage license is being transferred.



FLLM's ABT-6002 guide connects the transaction roadmap, current official form, and DBPR transfer checklist.

- 01 Document the commercial deal**
The parties identify the license, price, deposit, timing, contingencies, and closing obligations in their transaction documents.
- 02 Prepare the application file**
The applicant provides required ownership and interested-party information. The transferor supplies the applicable affidavits or transfer information, and the parties assemble required attachments.
- 03 Add transaction-specific requirements**
Depending on the applicant and premises, the checklist may call for fingerprints, arrest dispositions, moral-character mitigation, right of occupancy, a premises sketch, tax items, zoning, health approval, a bond, or other support.
- 04 Submit through the official channel**
FLLM's workspace can help prepare and review the current official PDF, but the user must follow the current DBPR/DABT filing and payment instructions.

NOT A CLOSING DOCUMENT BY ITSELF

A signed ABT-6002 component does not by itself replace the complete applicant filing, the parties' purchase agreement, lien releases, escrow instructions, or DABT approval. Use the entire required filing package and the agreed closing structure.

OFFICIAL SOURCE DBPR Transfer of Ownership checklist; F.A.C. Rule 61A-5.010; current official ABT-6002 instructions.

09C • APPLICANT QUALIFICATION

Fingerprinting and the background-review process

Fingerprint and criminal-history requirements can affect completeness and timing. Follow the current DABT checklist for each person who must qualify.

01	Confirm who must be fingerprinted The transfer checklist states “if applicable.” Existing licensees or particular participants may be treated differently under the current instructions, so do not assume every person needs a new submission—or that no one does.
02	Use an approved Livescan provider In-state applicants may use an FDLE-approved Livescan provider. Provide the Alcoholic Beverages and Tobacco ORI number FL920150Z so results are routed correctly to DBPR.
03	Coordinate timing with the application DBPR’s general fingerprint guidance says an application should precede fingerprint submission, while ABT materials may provide filing-specific timing guidance. Follow the current instructions and retain the provider receipt and Transaction Control Number.
04	Bring proper identification DBPR states that applicants need two forms of identification at the electronic-fingerprinting site, including one bearing a photograph and signature.
05	Address record issues completely If applicable, the transfer checklist may require certified arrest dispositions and mitigation relating to moral character. Disclose accurately and obtain legal advice when a criminal-history or eligibility issue may be material.
06	Track results and deficiencies FDLE/FBI process the prints and DBPR receives the result. Incorrect ORI information, illegible prints, expired results, or missing documentation can delay the application and may require correction or a re-roll.

OUT-OF-STATE APPLICANTS

DABT directs out-of-state alcoholic-beverage applicants to contact the division for the appropriate fingerprint card and instructions. Do not send an ordinary card without confirming the current ABT procedure.

OFFICIAL SOURCE DBPR Fingerprinting page and FAQs; DBPR Transfer of Ownership checklist. ORI: FL920150Z. Requirements and timing should be reconfirmed before submission.

09A • PUBLIC DRAWING

The quota-license drawing: opportunity, not certainty

01

Availability is county-specific

The annual notice identifies counties and the number of newly available quota licenses.

02

Entry is time-limited

Use the current DBPR notice and official entry method. The statutory entry fee is \$100 for each entry form.

03

One entry rule

Florida law generally limits a person, firm, or corporation to one application in the drawing process.

04

Selection starts the application clock

A selected applicant generally has 45 days after the division mails notice of selection to file the license application.

05

Qualification still applies

Selection does not waive applicant, premises, tax, disclosure, or other licensing requirements.

06

A premises may come later

The statute permits issuance into inactive status in certain circumstances when the selected applicant is not ready to place the license at a qualified business.

PLANNING ADVICE

Do not make an opening date depend solely on winning a drawing. Maintain a parallel plan: monitor existing quota inventory and evaluate non-quota or special-license eligibility if appropriate.

OFFICIAL SOURCE § 561.19, Fla. Stat. (2026); Florida DBPR, Quota Licenses & Drawings and official entry checklist.

10 • MARKETPLACE SUPPORT

One website serving six connected roles

The user should know which FLLM role is being used because the service, responsibility, and level of support are different.

FLLM role	What the website or service provides	Important boundary
Market data website	Current inventory, disclosed asking prices, county markets, research, heat maps, market index information, source context, and downloadable data	Marketplace data is not automatically a verified closed-sale database or formal appraisal
Valuation and appraisal service	Preliminary market information, pricing analysis, lender-oriented research, and formal appraisal assignments with a defined scope when engaged	The selected product, effective date, assumptions, intended use, and acceptance requirements control
Florida liquor-license platform	Listings, county and license-type pages, financing resources, transaction tools, form access, inquiries, and offers in one statewide destination	Platform use alone does not create representation or guarantee listing accuracy, availability, financing, or approval
Self-directed listing service	Low-cost marketplace exposure and buyer-inquiry routing for sellers or independent brokers managing their own transaction	No FLLM brokerage representation or commission service is included unless separately agreed
Professional buyer / seller broker	Sourcing or marketing, pricing strategy, confidential communications, negotiation, and transaction coordination within an accepted written engagement	The written agreement defines the client, scope, compensation, and services; outside professional and regulatory work remains separate
Educational website	Plain-language licensing, quota, application, form, statute, finance, valuation, and due-diligence resources linked to official sources	Education and form preparation are not legal advice and do not replace DABT or other agency requirements

FLLM'S ROLE

FLLM may serve different functions for different users, but it is not the regulator. Unless separately agreed in writing, FLLM is not acting as legal counsel, tax adviser, lender, underwriter, escrow agent, fiduciary, or government filing authority.

Start a confidential conversation

Visit FloridaLiquorLicenseMarket.com/contact and include your county, role (buyer, seller, applicant, or lender), license type if known, budget or expected value, timing, and the help you want.

10A • PROFESSIONAL DIRECTORY

Use the FLLM Lawyers Directory to identify the legal experience the transaction requires

The directory helps users compare published practice information and then verify the attorney directly and through The Florida Bar.



FLLM Lawyers Directory: licensing, transactions, lien/tax/closing work, litigation, and appeals are organized as distinct practice needs.

Browse by the type of legal work rather than assuming every business lawyer or licensing lawyer handles the same matters.

Open the attorney or firm profile, review published practice information, and verify current standing directly with The Florida Bar.

Contact prospective counsel to confirm experience, conflicts, availability, fee structure, and the scope of the proposed engagement.

10A • CHOOSING COUNSEL

Match the legal assignment to the lawyer's actual experience

A purchase agreement, ABT filing, lien problem, escrow closing, civil dispute, and appeal may require different experience—and sometimes different counsel.

Legal need	Examples of work to ask about
Licensing and regulatory	ABT applications, transfers, temporary licenses, compliance, agency correspondence, hearings, and enforcement matters.
Transactions and transfers	Purchase agreements, representations, contingencies, due diligence, entity authority, and transfer documentation.
Liens, tax, escrow, and closing	Recorded interests, payoff and release documents, tax-clearance issues, escrow instructions, and closing delivery.
Litigation and appeals	Ownership disputes, specific-performance claims, injunctions, administrative review, preservation, briefing, and appeals.

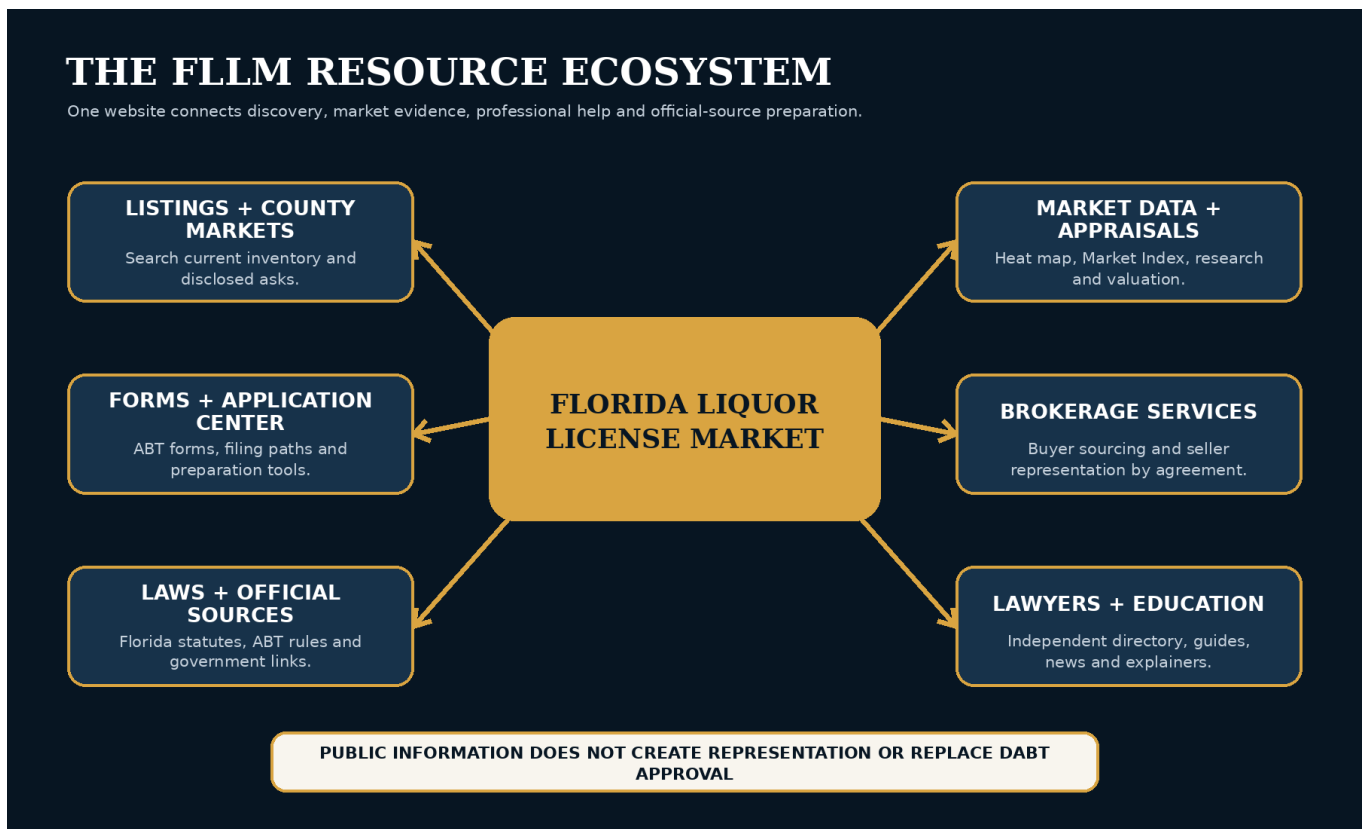
HOW TO USE THE DIRECTORY

Confirm the lawyer's actual experience with the specific issue, availability, fees, conflicts, office location, and Florida Bar status. Directory inclusion is not an endorsement, ranking, certification, or lawyer referral.

10B • RESOURCE ECOSYSTEM

See how the website's tools connect

FLLM is designed so a user can move from education and market discovery to professional help and official-source preparation without confusing those functions.



FLLM resource map: marketplace, data, valuation, forms, laws, directories, education, and brokerage are connected but remain distinct services.

Discovery resources include the listings page, 67 county market pages, heat map, license-type pages, and Research Center.

Transaction resources include brokerage services, valuation and appraisal options, financing information, forms, calculators, and the Lawyers Directory.

Regulatory and educational resources include the Application Center, ABT form guides, Laws page, official-agency links, news, and plain-language explainers.

CHOOSE THE CORRECT FUNCTION

A web page can educate, route, or organize a process. It does not itself verify every fact, create representation, constitute an appraisal, provide legal advice, or produce government approval.

10C • RESEARCH AND REFERENCE

Use the Research Center as the website's source-transparent starting point

The Research Center collects market evidence, downloadable data, county references, valuation tools, forms, fees, and official sources in one place.



The screenshot shows the Florida Liquor License Market Research Center website. The header includes the logo and navigation links: Market Index, County Data, License Fees, and Quota Lottery. The main section is titled "Florida Liquor License Data & Research" and describes it as a source-transparent research hub. It features two buttons: "OPEN MARKET INDEX" and "DOWNLOAD CURRENT CSV". A sidebar for "AUGUST 2026" displays key metrics: Active marketplace listings (197), Counties with inventory (37), and Median disclosed ask (\$380,000). Below this is a "REFERENCE LIBRARY" section titled "Link-worthy Florida liquor-license resources", which provides specific source pages for professionals. Three resource cards are shown: 01. Florida Liquor License Market Index (Statewide 4COP and 3PS inventory, disclosed asking-price medians, county rankings and downloadable CSV data), 02. All 67 County Markets (County population, active inventory, 4COP and 3PS asking-price evidence and local market pages), and 03. Quota Drawing Data (Current Florida quota drawing information with official DBPR references and county availability).

FLLM Research Center: current inventory metrics, disclosed asking-price context, downloadable data, and a reference library.

Use the dated Market Index and CSV when the date and source of a market statistic matter.

Move from statewide metrics to county pages, then to the underlying listings that produced the displayed asking-price evidence.

Use the source-transparency notes to distinguish marketplace asking prices from appraisals and verified closed-sale evidence.

10D • WEBSITE RESOURCE DIRECTORY

Know which FLLM resource answers which question

Start with the user's decision: finding inventory, comparing value, financing a transaction, investing private capital, preparing a filing, locating authority, or assembling professional help.

Resource	What it helps a user do
Market Index and current CSV	Review a dated statewide snapshot of active inventory, disclosed asking prices, county rankings, and downloadable data.
All 67 county markets	Compare county-specific inventory and disclosed 4COP/3PS asking-price evidence.
Listings and heat map	Move from statewide discovery to an individual listing and source-specific inquiry path.
Value center and appraisals	Distinguish preliminary market information, broker pricing work, and formal appraisal assignments.
Financing, investment, and SDIRA pages	Request borrower financing, join the private-lender network, review investment risks, or engage FLLM's \$495 administrative IRA setup assistance.
Application Center, forms, and fees	Identify a filing path, locate the current official form, and organize preparation materials.
Laws, official sources, and lawyers	Read the governing references, reach official agency pages, and identify independent counsel for legal work.

11 • ACTION SHEETS

Buyer, seller, and applicant checklists

Buyer	Seller	Applicant
☐ Define privileges and county	☐ Verify ownership, series, county, and status	☐ Identify the exact license path
☐ Set total project budget	☐ Identify liens and payoff requirements	☐ Confirm entity and owner disclosures
☐ Search and compare inventory	☐ Define included/excluded assets	☐ Secure premises rights if required
☐ Verify license and seller	☐ Prepare market evidence and pricing	☐ Obtain zoning/local confirmations
☐ Review liens, taxes, and claims	☐ Choose public or confidential marketing	☐ Register/coordinate with DOR
☐ Confirm premises and zoning	☐ Screen buyer funding and timing	☐ Complete fingerprints/background items
☐ Negotiate contingencies	☐ Negotiate agreement and escrow terms	☐ Use the current ABT online filing
☐ Secure financing	☐ Prepare releases and entity approvals	☐ Pay current government fees
☐ File correct ABT application	☐ Cooperate with the application	☐ Track requests and deadlines
☐ Close under written instructions	☐ Close and preserve records	☐ Do not operate outside issued authority

PRINT THIS PAGE

Use these lists to assign an owner and due date for each item. “Complete” should mean you retained the supporting evidence—not merely that someone said it was handled.

11A • BETTER QUESTIONS

What to ask before committing

Buyer → seller or representative

What is the exact license number, series, county, named owner, and current status?

Is the license offered alone, with a business, with a lease, or with real estate?

What liens, security interests, taxes, claims, or transfer issues exist—and how will each be released or cured?

What is the evidence supporting the asking price and what transaction terms are assumed?

Seller → buyer

Who is the proposed applicant and intended operator?

What privileges, county, premises, and opening timeline does the buyer require?

Is proof of funds available, or what financing stage has been reached?

What contingencies, diligence access, and closing timeline are requested?

Either party → broker / coordinator

Whom do you represent, what services are included, and how are you compensated?

Which facts are verified, which are seller- or buyer-provided, and what must be independently confirmed?

Who will handle the contract, escrow, lien work, tax matters, filing, and closing?

What is the next decision, what evidence is needed, and who owns the deadline?

11B • GLOSSARY

Florida liquor-license terms in plain language

Verify the exact series, modifier, county, privileges, and current DBPR record before relying on shorthand.

Term	Meaning
APS	Package-sales suffix used for sealed-container sales for consumption away from the licensed premises.
COP	Consumption on premises; a suffix indicating that authorized beverages may be sold for consumption at the licensed premises.
Quota license	A county-limited full-liquor license in the 3PS or COP family, generally limited to one affected license per 7,500 county residents, subject to exceptions.
2APS	Beer and wine in sealed containers for off-premises consumption; not a full-liquor quota license.
2COP	Beer and wine for consumption on premises; sealed-container sales may be allowed subject to law and local ordinance; no distilled spirits.
3PS	Common label for the quota package-store family authorizing sealed-container sales of beer, wine, and spirits for off-premises consumption.
4COP	Common label for the quota COP family authorizing beer, wine, and spirits by the drink or in sealed containers for consumption on or off premises, subject to the exact series and law.
SFS	Special Food Service; the current DBPR modifier for a qualifying restaurant special license with premises, seating, meal-service, and revenue requirements.
SRX	Special restaurant exception; terminology still used in DBPR's restaurant FAQ and by industry participants for the restaurant exception to the quota system.
SFX	Not a standard current DBPR license series. It is sometimes used or typed when the speaker appears to mean SFS or SRX; confirm the actual DBPR record.
13CT	Caterer license for a qualifying caterer; the statutory 51% food-and-nonalcoholic revenue test applies at each catered event.
ABT-6001	Principal DBPR form used for many original alcoholic-beverage applications and identified changes under current instructions.
ABT-6002	DBPR transfer-of-ownership application used when an existing alcoholic-beverage license is transferred.
DABT / ABT	Florida Division of Alcoholic Beverages and Tobacco within the Department of Business and Professional Regulation.

WEBSITE GLOSSARY

The current FLLM glossary and food-sales chart are available at FloridaLiquorLicenseMarket.com/resources/florida-liquor-license-glossary.



OFFICIAL RESOURCES

Use current government sources

Accessed August 29, 2026. Always confirm that the page, form, statute, and fee are still current.

[Florida DBPR — Alcoholic Beverages & Tobacco](#)

[DBPR — Quota Licenses & Drawings](#)

[DBPR — Forms & Publications](#)

[DBPR — Fingerprinting guidance and Livescan information](#)

[DBPR — Transfer of Ownership checklist](#)

[DBPR — License Types & Privileges \(PDF\)](#)

[Florida Division of Corporations — Start a Business](#)

[Florida Statutes § 561.17 — Applications](#)

[Florida Statutes § 561.19 — Issuance / drawing](#)

[Florida Statutes § 561.20 — Quota limitation](#)

[Florida Statutes § 561.32 — Transfers](#)

[Florida Statutes § 561.331 — Temporary licenses](#)

[Florida Statutes § 561.65 — Mortgagee / lien interests](#)

[Florida DOR — Alcoholic Beverage License Approvals](#)

DBPR Customer Contact Center: 850-487-1395 (verify current office routing on the DBPR contact page).

FLLM resource gateways

[FLLM Application Center](#)

[FLLM Florida ABT Forms](#)

[FLLM ABT-6002 Transfer Guide](#)

[FLLM Research Hub](#)

[FLLM Market Index](#)

[FLLM Florida Liquor License Laws](#)

[FLLM License Glossary and Food-Sales Chart](#)

[FLLM Lawyers Directory](#)

[FLLM Brokerage Services](#)

[FLLM Borrower Financing](#)

[FLLM Investment Opportunities](#)

[FLLM Self-Directed IRA Lending and Setup Assistance](#)

[IRS Prohibited-Transaction Guidance](#)



YOUR NEXT MOVE

Turn the guide into an action plan

Tell Florida Liquor License Market what you are trying to accomplish. A concise fact pattern lets the marketplace team route you to the right inventory, listing path, valuation scope, financing conversation, or application checklist.

INCLUDE THESE SIX FACTS

1) Buyer, seller, applicant, or lender • 2) County • 3) License type or intended privileges • 4) Budget, asking price, or value question • 5) Desired timing • 6) Whether a premises or counterparty is already identified

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